
Introduction

Team building, or community formation, lies at the heart of transdisciplinary work. The following pages in the base camp will tell you more about the different dimensions of collaboration in a transdisciplinary environment.

Let's start with the basics. Team building is essential in two areas of transdisciplinary projects:

- Within your project group
- From your project outward, toward as many relevant stakeholders as possible

Starting with your own group: you've likely experienced that collaboration is an art in itself. In this TRAIL, we return to this topic often. Working together in a transdisciplinary team is especially complex due to the diversity of team members — differences that must ultimately be merged into innovative knowledge.

Secondly, it's important to begin building social relationships with the *field* surrounding the societal issue from the very start. This field helps you better understand the challenge and come up with solutions. Expanding your network also helps you find the right new people to join the project team.

In transdisciplinary work, it's crucial to stay alert to missing participants and perspectives. When you take on a coordinating role, it's up to you and your team to decide how to involve stakeholders in the project: as advisors, sparring partners, local guides, or researchers.

Under the **Theory** section, you'll find insights from scientific research on team building and the motivations of participants to engage in multi-, inter-, or transdisciplinary collaborations.

The **Practice** page will soon offer tools and approaches you can use to foster group formation.

Note: In-depth pages for theory and practice are not yet fully available on this topic. Some authors of the TRAIL tool are currently working on a review study of transdisciplinary collaborations. Knowledge from this study will be added here soon.

You can already check out an introduction to this new research and the researchers here: [Scoping review transdisciplinaire samenwerkingen | Avans Hogeschool](#)

Sign up for the TRAIL newsletter to stay informed about content updates.

Theory

Students are, of course, important partners in collaborations within transdisciplinary education.

It's still unclear whether students are actively seeking collaborative activities to gain trans-, inter-, and multidisciplinary experiences.

Lecturer-researcher **Margot Ploumen** from Avans University of Applied Sciences is currently researching the expectations and experiences of students in a multidisciplinary collaboration project.

You can read more about that research here: [Onderzoek naar multidisciplinair samenwerken van engineering studenten | Avans Hogeschool](#)

Practice

*Transdisciplinary work is a process — and gathering knowledge about it is too. More information will follow soon. **Sign up for the TRAIL newsletter** to stay informed about content updates!*